

PowerShell Open-Sourced!

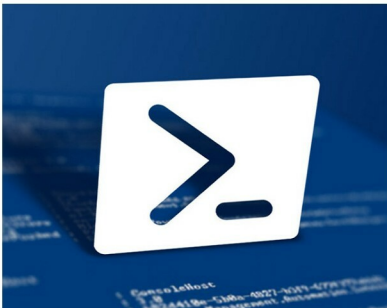
PowerShell is an automation and configuration framework from Microsoft. It consists of a command-line shell and an associated scripting language based on the .NET framework. Microsoft recently open sourced PowerShell, and made it supportable on the Linux and Mac operating systems.

With the advent of DevOps and cloud technologies, customers are experimenting more and more with multi-platform, multi-cloud or multi-OS based applications. This shift in customer demand and set-up environments has led to a new set of challenges for developers and IT administrators who manage such complex infrastructure, as the

code written in one platform needs to be supported on other platforms, too. In such scenarios, customers also need to look for tools that are interoperable across several platforms, and ensure faster and continuous business delivery.

MS Azure is a growing collection of integrated cloud services that developers and IT professionals use to build, deploy and manage applications. With one in every three virtual machines at MS Azure hosting Linux, Microsoft realised the need to adopt an open source, customer-centric approach to deliver services. As a first step in that direction, MS announced that it had made PowerShell open source and also made it supportable on the Linux and Mac operating systems. Currently, the support is provided for Linux flavours like RHEL, Centos and Ubuntu.

PowerShell is a task-based command-line shell and scripting language built on the .NET framework to help IT professionals control and automate the administration of the Windows, Linux and Mac OSs as well as the applications that run on them. As PowerShell is built on top of the .NET framework, .NET Core has been ported to Linux. This enables customers to use a single management stack to manage all workloads. Now, developers and IT administrators can experience a rich interactive scripting language, as well as heterogeneous automation and configuration management that just works perfectly. Also,



MS is partnering with a number of industry-leading third-party companies like Chef, Amazon Web Services, VMware and Google, to name a few – to create a seamless experience across all platforms for end users.

Installing PowerShell

PowerShell has been open sourced to GitHub under the MIT licence (<https://github.com/PowerShell/PowerShell>). Installing PowerShell has been made easy.

To install PowerShell on Ubuntu 14.04 and above, navigate to <https://github.com/PowerShell/PowerShell/releases/tag/v6.0.0-alpha.17> and download the Debian package for the respective Ubuntu OS version (for example, if the Ubuntu version is 16.04 then download the package `powershell_6.0.0-alpha.15-1ubuntu1.16.04.1_amd64.deb`). Open a terminal and run the following commands:

```
sudo dpkg -i powershell_6.0.0-alpha.15-1ubuntu1.16.04.1_
amd64.deb
sudo apt-get install -f
```

To install on Centos 7, give the following command:

```
sudo yum install ./powershell-6.0.0_alpha.15-1.el7.centos.
x86_64.rpm
```

...or type the following:

```
sudo yum install https://github.com/PowerShell/PowerShell/
releases/download/v6.0.0-alpha.15/powershell-6.0.0_
alpha.15-1.el7.centos.x86_64.rpm
```

Running PowerShell without installation

If you wish to play around with PowerShell and not